

Running ControlPlane Checker

Setup & Usage Guide

Team DLS · Accenture Innovation Challenge 2026

Document date: 27 Aug 2026

This guide covers two ways to run the app — Docker Compose (recommended) and running the backend and frontend natively — plus how to submit your own prompts and responses through the dashboard instead of relying only on the seed script.

1. Prerequisites

Pick ONE path below. You don't need both.

Path	Requires	Best for
A: Docker Compose	Docker Desktop (with WSL2 on Windows)	One command, matches what the team's README and CI assume
B: Native (no Docker)	Python 3.11+ and Node.js 20+ installed directly	Machines where Docker isn't available or installing it is blocked

2. Path A — Run with Docker Compose

Step 1: Install WSL2 (Windows only, skip on Mac/Linux)

Open PowerShell **as Administrator** and run the command below. Restart your computer afterward — it will not take effect until you do.

```
wsl --install
```

Step 2: Install Docker Desktop

Download it from docker.com/products/docker-desktop, run the installer, and keep the default options (ensure "Use WSL 2 instead of Hyper-V" is checked if you're asked). Restart your computer again after install.

Step 3: Launch Docker Desktop

Open it from the Start menu and wait until it says "Docker Desktop is running" (the whale icon in the system tray stops animating). You can skip sign-in — it isn't required for local use.

Step 4: Open a fresh terminal and verify

Close any terminal windows that were open before you installed Docker, then open a new one so the PATH refreshes. Run:

```
docker --version
docker compose version
```

Both should print version numbers. If docker still isn't recognized here, Docker Desktop isn't running yet — check the tray icon.

Step 5: Run the project

From the project folder:

```
cd controlplane-checker
docker compose up --build
```

The first run takes a few minutes while it pulls base images and installs dependencies. Watch for both of these lines before continuing:

```
backend-1 | INFO: Uvicorn running on http://0.0.0.0:8000
frontend-1 | VITE ready in ... ms
```

Step 6: Verify it's up

Open these two URLs in a browser:

- `http://localhost:8000/health` → should show `{"status":"ok"}`
- `http://localhost:5173` → should show the dashboard

Step 7: Seed some demo data (optional)

In a second terminal, leaving docker compose up running in the first:

```
cd controlplane-checker
python demo/seed_transactions.py
```

Watch the dashboard at `localhost:5173` update live as it runs.

3. Path B — Run natively (no Docker)

Use this if Docker isn't available. Commands below are for Windows PowerShell; the same steps work on Mac/Linux with minor syntax differences (noted where relevant).

Step 1: Start the backend

Open a terminal in the backend folder and run:

```
cd controlplane-checker\backend
pip install -r requirements.txt
$env:PYTHONPATH = "."
python -m uvicorn app.main:app --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8000
```

Two Windows-specific notes baked into the commands above:

- Use `python -m uvicorn ...` rather than plain `uvicorn ...` — pip on Windows often installs the `uvicorn.exe` script to a folder that isn't on PATH, so calling it as a Python module sidesteps that entirely.
- `$env:PYTHONPATH = "."` is PowerShell syntax; on Mac/Linux use `export PYTHONPATH=.` instead.

You should see:

```
INFO: Uvicorn running on http://0.0.0.0:8000
INFO: Application startup complete.
```

Step 2: Verify the backend

Open `http://localhost:8000/health` in a browser (simpler than curl on Windows, which routes through Invoke-WebRequest and shows a script-execution warning). You should see:

```
{"status": "ok"}
```

Step 3: Point the frontend at the right backend URL

Since there's no Docker network here, edit `frontend/vite.config.ts` and change:

```
target: 'http://backend:8000',
```

to:

```
target: 'http://localhost:8000',
```

Step 4: Start the frontend

In a second terminal:

```
cd controlplane-checker\frontend
npm install
npm run dev
```

Open `http://localhost:5173` — that's the dashboard.

Step 5: Seed some demo data (optional)

In a third terminal:

```
cd controlplane-checker
python demo/seed_transactions.py
```

4. Can I type in my own queries? Yes.

The dashboard has a **"Score a response manually"** form sitting directly above the live feed. You don't need the seed script at all — it exists only as a convenience to populate the dashboard quickly with a mix of examples.

4.1 How to use it

- **Prompt** box: the question or instruction you're pretending was sent to an LLM.
- **Response** box: the text you want scored — paste in whatever you want to test.
- **Model** dropdown: which per-model cost rate to score against (affects the cost check only).
- **Session id**: groups related submissions together — the correlation engine's repeated-flag escalation rule only looks within the same session id.
- Click **Score it**. The result appears in the live feed instantly, exactly like a seeded response, because the backend broadcasts every scored record to all connected dashboards over WebSocket regardless of where it came from.

4.2 Things worth trying

Try typing this into Response	What it should trigger
Any normal sentence with no personal data	severity: pass
"I'm not sure, I cannot verify this, it's difficult to say"	severity: log (hedging language lowers the performance/confidence score)
A response containing an email address or phone number	severity: block, and the stored excerpt is redacted before it's saved
A very long, repetitive, hedging response on an expensive model (e.g. gpt-4o)	may trigger the cost_confidence_mismatch correlation flag

This is the fastest way to demo the tool live — type a clean response first (pass), then paste one with an email in it right after (block), and point out that the compound correlation flag can fire without needing the seed script at all.

5. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
'docker' is not recognized	Docker Desktop isn't installed or isn't running. See Section 2, Steps 2-4. Always open a fresh terminal after installing.
'uvicorn' is not recognized	Run it as a module instead: <code>python -m uvicorn app.main:app ...</code> (Section 3, Step 1).
curl shows a 'Script Execution Risk' warning on Windows	That's PowerShell's curl alias (Invoke-WebRequest) being cautious, not an error. Type Y, or just open the URL in a browser instead.
Frontend loads but the live feed never connects / dashboard shows 'reconnecting'	Check vite.config.ts points at the right backend URL: localhost:8000 for native, backend:8000 for Docker (Section 3, Step 3).
ModuleNotFoundError: No module named 'app'	PYTHONPATH isn't set. Re-run the <code>\$env:PYTHONPATH = "."</code> line before starting uvicorn (Section 3, Step 1).